Ambition Roadmap and Decision Register

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Summary

Ambition is an agentic commerce research and education platform on Sui, written in Move from the first module, with stablecoins at its center. AI agents will pay for things in digital dollars, so Ambition teaches builders how an agent holds and spends stablecoins safely. It also scores every payment rail and stablecoin on one public scorecard, and ships the toolkit that does the spending.

The platform has three parts that feed each other. The toolkit gives an agent a wallet, a spending cap it cannot exceed, payments that settle with their receipts, escrow and alerts. The research desk uses that toolkit to buy data and publish cited briefs on which rails and stablecoins are safe for agents. The education track turns each module into a lesson and a reader challenge that leaves public proof on Sui's test network.

Sui carries the build because its base layer already does what agent payments need. One transaction can settle several steps at once, a spending limit can be an object the agent holds, and beginners can sign in and pay without buying gas. The research stays neutral anyway, because a referee that favors its own rail would lose the trust that makes its briefs worth buying.

Every decision below was accepted on November 4, 2026. This roadmap replaces the earlier Base and Solidity roadmap, which is kept unchanged as a dated record of its decisions, D-01 to D-26. The plan stays dateless, and dates return when the capstone course begins (P-15).

Why this platform

Starting from a blank page, three ambitious DeFi paths on Sui were weighed, and only the platform is both ambitious and reachable for one builder. The other two need licenses or capital that a student project cannot raise, and Sui's largest players already hold them.

Path	Verdict	Why
Issue a stablecoin	No	Under the GENIUS Act, only a regulated "permitted payment stablecoin issuer" may issue one to people in the US, and the law is expected to take effect January 18, 2027. Sui already has dollars from Circle (USDC), Bridge, a Stripe company (USDsui), and Ethena with SUI Group (suiUSDe, plus USDi backed by BlackRock's tokenized money-market fund)
Build a trading, lending or derivatives protocol	No	Sui already has DeepBook's shared order book, Suilend, NAVI and Bluefin. The May 2025 Cetus exploit showed that one math bug in an exchange can drain over $220 million, so a new protocol needs deep capital and repeated audits
Build an agentic commerce research and education platform	Yes	It sits one layer above the stablecoins, so it needs no license to issue and no pool of other people's money. It uses exactly the Sui features that make agent payments safe, and a neutral scorecard of rails and stablecoins is something no one offers today

The stablecoin angle survives inside the winning path. Ambition studies, teaches and uses stablecoins rather than issuing one, which keeps the ambition while staying outside the issuer rules. This is a summary of public reporting, not legal advice.

The case study

The case study is Ambition itself, growing from one agent with a wallet into a governed desk that other builders' agents pay for research. It replaces the book's fictional macro-research firm with a real subject, agents paying in stablecoins, so every lesson Ambition teaches is also a part it runs.

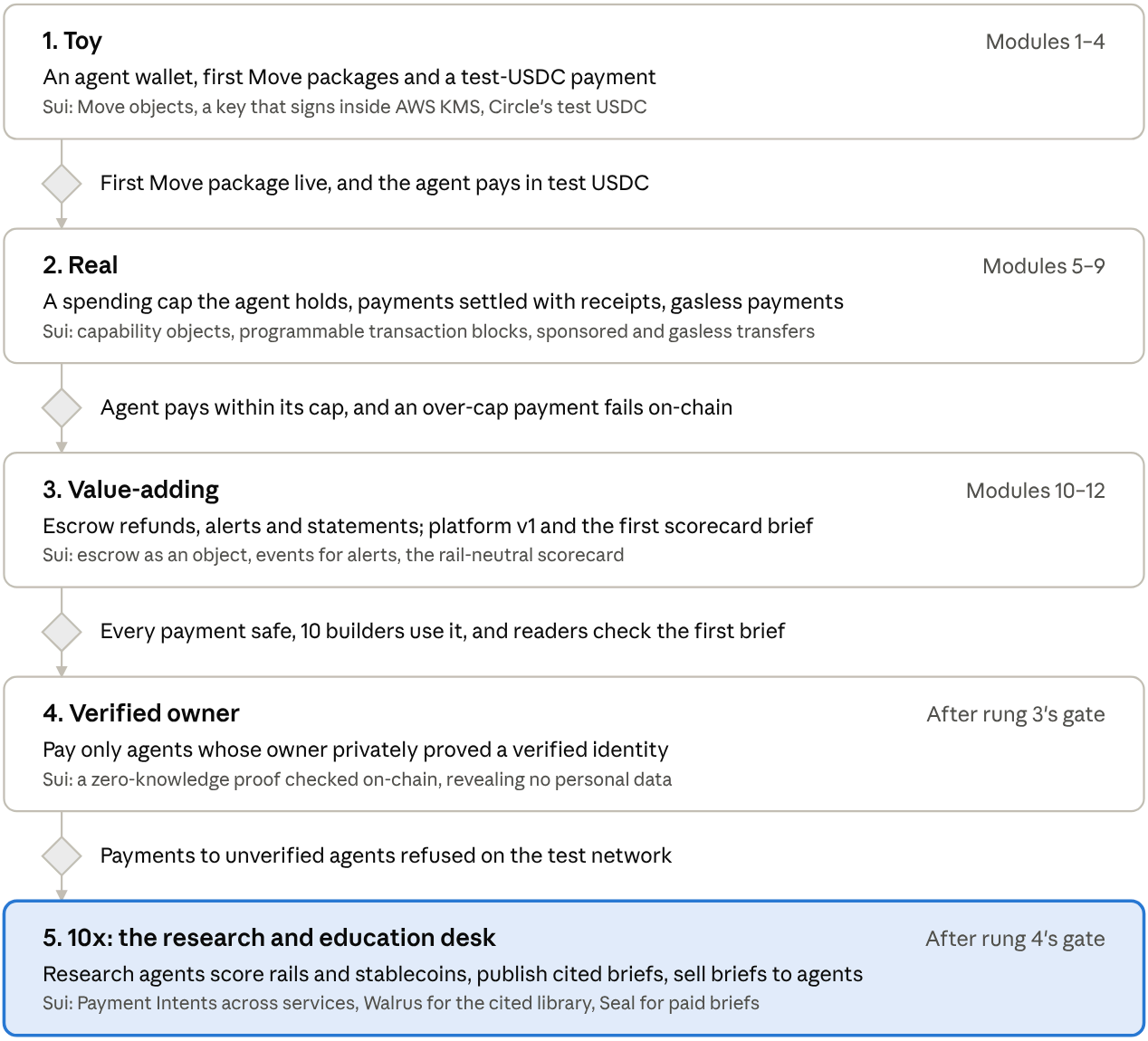
Part	What it does	The Sui features it uses
Toolkit	Gives an agent a wallet whose key never leaves AWS KMS, a spending cap it holds as an object, payments that settle together with their receipts, escrow with automatic refunds, alerts and statements	Move objects for the spending cap, programmable transaction blocks (up to 1,024 steps that all succeed or all fail), gasless stablecoin transfers, and Mysten's AWS KMS signer
Research desk	Buys public data with the toolkit and publishes cited briefs that score each rail and stablecoin on the same scorecard. It covers risk, safety and how-to, never price calls or personal recommendations	The toolkit's own payments, so every brief is also a live test; Walrus to store the cited library and Seal to control who reads paid briefs, if the desk needs them
Education	Turns each module into a plain-language lesson and a reader challenge that leaves public proof on the test network	zkLogin, so a beginner signs in with a familiar login, and sponsored transactions, so a reader's first payment needs no SUI for gas

The three parts feed each other. A reader learns a module, the toolkit gains a tested part, and the desk spends through that part to produce research. Sui's Payment Intents, which settle one request across several apps at once, join once the desk buys from more than one service in a single step.

The ladder

Five rungs take Ambition from one agent with a wallet to a desk that other agents pay for research, and each rung closes on a gate anyone can check. A missed gate holds the next rung rather than lowering the bar, and dates return when the capstone course begins.

Each rung closes on a gate, from one agent to a paid research desk



Platform ladder · 5 rungs, 4 gates

Rungs 1 to 3 hold the twelve modules. Rung 5 is now the platform's destination rather than one option among several, because the research and education desk is the case study.

Modules 1 to 12 in Move

Move starts in module 1, so every module ships a Move package on Sui's test network as well as a lesson. Each module is done when its check passes, and the order follows The Move Book: objects first, then coins, then the patterns that make agent payments safe. AWS joins in module 1 with a small foundation and adds one service at a time.

Module	What it builds on Sui	Reader challenge	What runs on AWS
1	An agent wallet whose key is created in AWS KMS, and a first Move package published to the test network	Get test SUI from the faucet, call the package and reply with the transaction link	Account guardrails and a budget alarm; the agent's key in KMS; a first Lambda that the CDK deploys from GitHub Actions through OIDC, writing the first release manifest
2	A statement: a script that reads the agent's activity and explains what an object and a checkpoint are	Find your transaction's checkpoint and reply with its number	An indexer Lambda reads the agent's transactions by checkpoint and writes the statement index to DynamoDB
3	A shared registry object where agents list a name and a price per request	Add an entry; each one is public proof	No new service, because the registry lives on Sui; the CDK stack gains its first tests
4	Test USDC from Circle's faucet and a payment from the agent to another wallet	Send 1 test USDC between two of your own wallets and reply with the link	A TypeScript signer Lambda signs through Mysten's KMS signer behind a first write-back gate that fails closed, and EventBridge Scheduler starts each run
5	A spending cap the agent holds as an object, with a budget, an expiry and an allowed-recipient list that the owner can suspend or revoke	Grant, then revoke, a cap and reply with the revocation	The gate checks the cap before signing, refused attempts go to the near-miss log, and the kill-switch runbook names its steps

Module	What it builds on Sui	Reader challenge	What runs on AWS
6	A paid service and a payment that settles with its receipt in one transaction, using Sui's own payment flow	Pay the service once and reply with the receipt object	The service runs on API Gateway and Lambda; the agent's loop calls Claude through Bedrock with a traffic-class tag and a per-run ceiling; the test set starts with 20 cases
7	Gasless stablecoin payments and sponsored transactions, so the agent and a new reader both pay without holding SUI	Make a first payment with zkLogin and a sponsored transaction	A sponsor Lambda with its own KMS key runs a gas station that pays readers' gas within a capped budget
8	Tests, a security checklist and a first kill-switch drill; the module-5 cap is compared with OpenZeppelin's spend vault for Sui	Try to overspend a test cap and reply with the failed transaction	An IAM review, the OWASP agentic-risk mapping, a first Well-Architected review and the first dated drill
9	Agent version 1: buys data, stays under its cap and logs every payment and refusal	Call the paid service from your own code	X-Ray traces every run, and the spending audit comes from CloudWatch Logs Insights
10	Escrow as an object that holds payment until delivery and refunds after a deadline	Pay into escrow, let the deadline pass and reply with your refund	The deadline lives in the Move object, and a one-time EventBridge Scheduler schedule claims the refund once it passes
11	Alerts and a public spending page	Trip an alert on your practice wallet and reply with the link	DynamoDB Streams trigger an alert Lambda that emails through SNS, and CloudFront serves the page from a private S3 bucket

Module	What it builds on Sui	Reader challenge	What runs on AWS
12	Ambition version 1, a capstone-style write-up and the first published scorecard brief	Read the brief and score one rail or stablecoin yourself	The architecture diagram, the Well-Architected review, a cost report from AWS Cost Explorer and the rung-3 gate review

The research desk starts small inside module 12 rather than waiting for a later rung. That way the first scorecard is tested by readers before the desk grows into the multi-agent research operation in rung 5. **Readers never need an AWS account,** because every challenge happens on Sui's test network.

The rail-neutral scorecard

Every chain and every stablecoin answers the same eight questions, Sui and its dollars included (P-04). Sui's own four questions test whether a rail can carry agent payments. The four Ambition adds test whether a builder can trust it, which is the part a vendor's checklist leaves out.

Question	Asked of	Why it matters to an agent
Can one workflow settle atomically across several services?	Rails	An agent that pays but never receives what it bought has lost money it cannot reverse
Can the protocol enforce a spending limit that travels across apps?	Rails	A limit that each app enforces separately fails the first time an app forgets
Do cost and throughput hold when one account drives thousands of payments?	Rails	Agents pay per request, so fees that look small per payment add up
Can the agent pay in stablecoins without managing gas?	Rails	An agent that must also hold the chain's own token has two balances to run out of

Question	Asked of	Why it matters to an agent
Can anyone, validators or issuers included, freeze or reverse a payment?	Rails and stablecoins	Sui's validators froze about $160 million after the Cetus exploit, and issuers can freeze their own coins, so builders should know who holds that power
Can a buyer get a refund when a service fails to deliver?	Rails	Payments are final, so refunds must be built in, usually as escrow
Can a reviewer trace why money moved?	Rails	An audit trail is what lets a team lead trust an agent with a budget
What backs the dollar, and who can redeem it?	Stablecoins	USDC holds cash and short-term Treasury reserves, USDsui is issued by Bridge to comply with the GENIUS Act, USDi is backed by a tokenized money-market fund, and suiUSDe is a synthetic dollar of digital assets hedged with short futures, so each can fail in a different way

Each brief scores one rail or stablecoin against these questions, cites a source for every answer, and says "insufficient evidence" where the sources run out.

Six safety habits

Six habits from *Building the Agentic Enterprise* carry over unchanged, because none of them depended on the chain (P-10). Each starts small in an early module, since every one is cheap to begin and expensive to bolt on later.

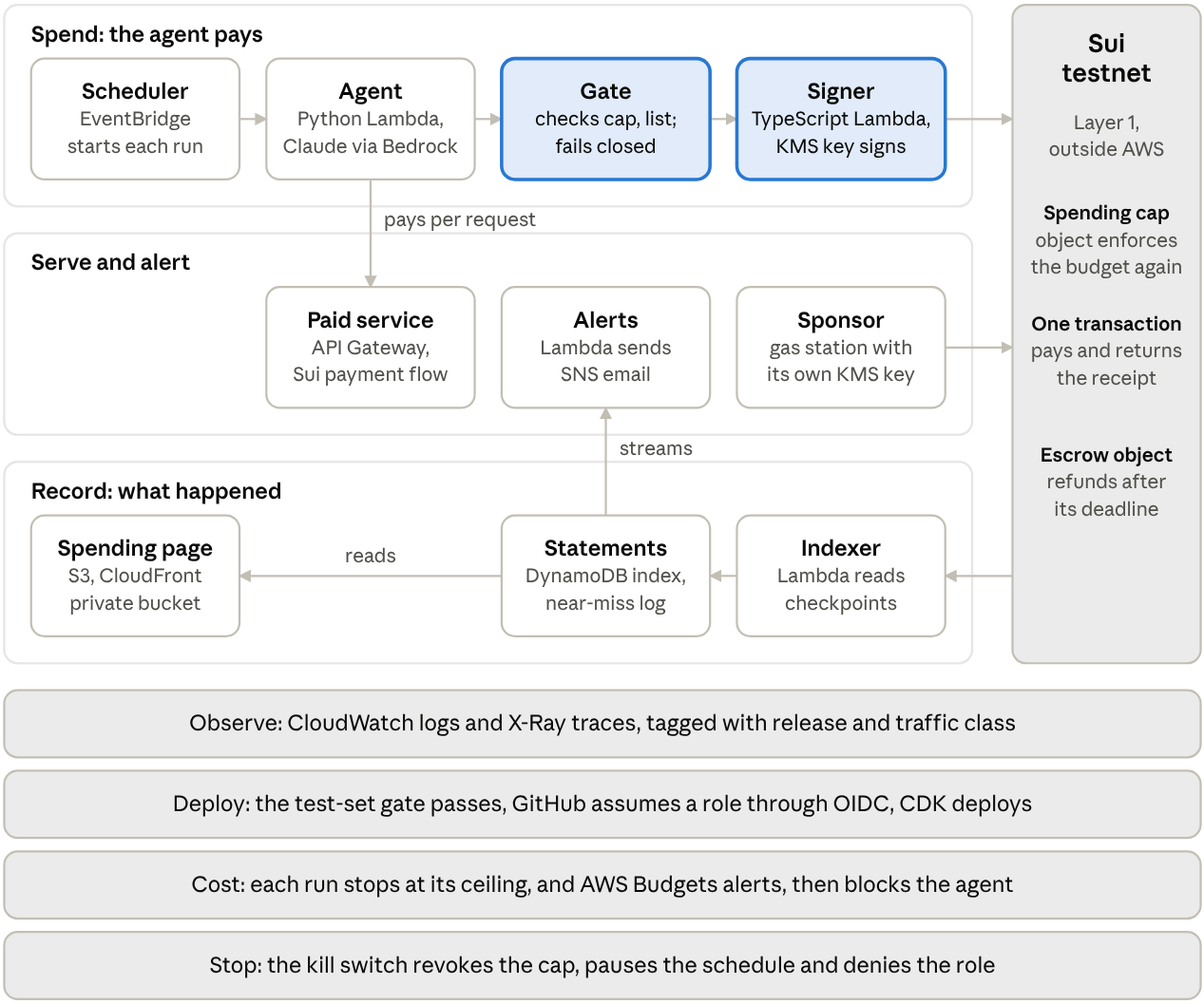
Habit	What Ambition does on Sui	Starts in	Book
Release manifest	Every deploy writes one file naming the model ID, prompt hashes, tool and library versions, Move package IDs and caps, and every statement line names the manifest it ran under	Module 1	pp. 421–425

Habit	What Ambition does on Sui	Starts in	Book
Write-back gate that fails closed	Nothing the agent proposes reaches the signer until the gate passes it, and an error, a timeout or a missing record counts as no (P-06)	Module 4, complete in module 5	pp. 303–304, 692
Kill switch with named steps	The runbook names each step the switch takes: revoke the spending cap, pause the schedule and deny the agent's IAM role. A drill at every rung gate from rung 2 on, dated in the log, proves it still stops a test agent within a minute	Module 5, first drill in module 8	pp. 524, 707
Test-set gate	The test set holds at least 20 cases. A quick set runs on every change and the full set nightly, against one pass bar, and overspending, a wrong recipient or a leaked key must pass 100%	Module 6	pp. 605, 705
Near-miss log	Every payment the gate refused or sent for approval is logged with its reason, because a near miss is the cheapest warning a system gives	Module 5	p. 467
Cost tags and a per-run ceiling	Every model call carries a traffic-class tag, such as agent run, test set or reader service. At 90% of a run's ceiling the agent switches to a cheaper model, and at 100% the run stops	Module 6	pp. 411, 518

The architecture on AWS and Sui

Every payment passes a gate in code, a signature inside KMS and the spending cap's own check on Sui before it settles. AWS runs the agent, its keys and its records, while Sui holds the money and the rules that must never be edited (P-11, P-12).

Every payment passes the gate, the KMS signer and the spending cap before it settles on Sui



Ambition on AWS and Sui · 3 lanes, 10 parts, 4 controls

The agent can propose any payment, but only the gate can pass one to the signer, only the signer holds the key, and the cap object refuses anything over its budget. The agent runs in Python and the signer in TypeScript, because Sui's official SDK and Mysten's KMS signer are TypeScript (P-09).

The design answers each of AWS's six Well-Architected pillars with a named control, and the rung-3 review checks them again.

Pillar	Ambition's answer
Operational excellence	Only GitHub Actions deploys, through the CDK stack; every deploy writes a release manifest, every run writes a structured log, and the kill switch is drilled at every rung gate from rung 2 on
Security	One least-privilege role per Lambda, a wallet key that signs only inside KMS, a spending cap that Sui enforces on its own, OIDC instead of stored keys, and a protected root login
Reliability	Lambda and DynamoDB run across several Availability Zones; reads retry with backoff, payments never retry blindly, the gate fails closed, and the index can be rebuilt from Sui
Performance efficiency	Each function gets its own memory size, and DynamoDB reads by wallet address, its fastest kind of lookup
Cost optimization	Lambda and DynamoDB stay inside their always-free allowances, every run stops at its cost ceiling, the gas station's budget is capped, and AWS Budgets alerts and then blocks the agent's roles
Sustainability	Nothing runs while idle, and DynamoDB TTL clears stale records

Books and curriculum

The books supply disciplines, not the case study. *Building the Agentic Enterprise* supplies the register, the gates and the six habits, cited by page. *Building AI Agents for Finance* supplies the agent safety rules in the reading notes. The Move Book and Sui's documentation supply Move and Sui.

The MSAIE's Cloud Applications and Architectures specialization supplies AWS, and its Blockchain specialization supplies the DeFi risks the scorecard checks. No book or course material goes into Git, because the books' and course's copyright and the Student Code of Conduct bar sharing them, so every fact here cites a public source (P-14).

Decision Register

Eighteen decisions make up the register, all accepted on November 4, 2026. Their P prefix comes from the proposal they were approved in and keeps them apart from the earlier D-01 to D-26, which live in the dated record. The book's own register holds fifteen rows and warns that more than thirty means decisions are being argued again, so a new decision takes the next ID, P-19, and changes to an old one edit its row.

ID	Decision	Status	Why	Revisit when
P-01	The case study is an agentic commerce research and education platform with three parts, a toolkit, a research desk and an education track, organized around how agents hold and spend stablecoins	Accepted	Each part feeds the others, and no one covers this subject neutrally today	Before module 1 ships
P-02	Build on Sui from module 1, with every on-chain part written in Move	Accepted	Sui's base layer already settles multi-step payments atomically, holds limits as objects and pays gas for beginners	Rung-3 review
P-03	Test money only on Sui's test network: no real-money account, no token and no stablecoin of Ambition's own	Accepted	Payments are final, beginners copy the build, and issuing a dollar requires a license under the GENIUS Act	After an independent audit

ID	Decision	Status	Why	Revisit when
P-04	Research is rail-neutral: one scorecard for every chain and stablecoin, Sui included. Briefs cover risk, safety and how-to, cite a source for every answer, may say "insufficient evidence", and never make price calls, trade signals or personal recommendations	Accepted	A referee that favors its own rail loses the trust that makes its briefs worth buying	Before any paid offer to people
P-05	The agent's spending authority is an object it holds, with a budget, an expiry and an allowed-recipient list the owner can suspend or revoke. Ambition builds its own in module 5 and compares it with OpenZeppelin's spend vault in module 8	Accepted	A limit the chain enforces holds even if every check before it fails	Module 8
P-06	Control lives outside the model: a write-back gate checks every payment and fails closed, and the agent's key is created in AWS KMS and never leaves it	Accepted	A fooled model or a crashed check still cannot overspend, and a key that never leaves KMS cannot leak	Only ever tightened
P-07	Every payment settles in the same transaction as its receipt	Accepted	An agent never pays without proof that it received what it bought	Module 6

ID	Decision	Status	Why	Revisit when
P-08	Readers onboard with zkLogin and sponsored transactions, and agents pay with gasless stablecoin transfers where Sui offers them	Accepted	Beginners never buy gas before a first payment, and agents manage one balance instead of two	Module 7
P-09	Move for on-chain code, TypeScript with Mysten's official SDK for the chain client and KMS signing, and Python for the agent, research and analysis	Accepted	Sui's official tools are TypeScript, and Python support rests on one volunteer maintainer	If an official Python SDK appears
P-10	The six safety habits carry over unchanged: release manifest, fail-closed write-back gate, kill switch with named steps and dated drills, test-set gate, near-miss log and per-run cost ceiling	Accepted	None of them depended on the chain	Each rung gate
P-11	The chain records what must never be edited, such as caps, payments and escrow deadlines, and any off-chain index can be rebuilt from it	Accepted	Anyone can verify the money, and losing the index costs nothing	Module 10

ID	Decision	Status	Why	Revisit when
P-12	AWS stays the cloud: KMS for keys, Lambda for the agent, DynamoDB for the index, and a budget that blocks the agent's roles	Accepted	It is the cloud the degree teaches, and Mysten's KMS signer works with it	Rung-3 cost review
P-13	The research charter excludes measuring fake or wash agent activity	Accepted	That work needs data access and legal review Ambition won't have, and it would turn a teaching desk into a policing one	Before rung 5
P-14	The Move Book and Sui's documentation join the two current books as reading sources, and no book or course material goes into Git	Accepted	Move replaces Solidity, and the books' and course's copyright and the Student Code of Conduct bar sharing them	Never, for the Git rule
P-15	The plan stays dateless: modules close on checks, rungs close on gates, and dates return when the capstone course begins	Accepted	A gate holds the bar where a date invites lowering it	When the capstone course begins
P-16	Keep the Ambition name and its public repository, with the GitLab mirror and the MIT License unchanged	Accepted	The mission still fits, and keeping the name keeps the repository, its history and readers' links intact	Only if the mission changes

ID	Decision	Status	Why	Revisit when
P-17	The paid service uses Sui's own payment flow, not a third-party x402 package	Accepted	x402 has no official Sui implementation, while Sui's own flow settles a payment and its receipt in one transaction with no outside code	If an official x402 implementation for Sui appears
P-18	Apply for a Sui grant or request for proposals, and for the next academic research award Sui announces, whether the 2026 or the 2027 round	Accepted	A grant can fund the build and an independent audit, and the 2025 award program has ended with no next round announced	When Sui announces the next award round

Plain-language terms

Term	Plain meaning
Agentic commerce	AI agents buying and selling on their own, paying per request in digital dollars
API Gateway	An AWS service that gives code a web address and decides which function answers each request
Atomic transaction	A set of steps that all succeed or all fail together, so nothing is left half done
AWS Budgets	AWS's spending alarms, which can also block chosen roles once the bill passes a set amount
AWS CDK	A toolkit for describing AWS resources in code, so the whole setup can be reviewed, tested and rebuilt
Bedrock	AWS's service for calling AI models such as Claude, authorized by AWS roles instead of a separate API key

Term	Plain meaning
Capability	An object that grants a power, such as spending up to a budget; whoever holds it has that power
Checkpoint	A numbered batch of Sui transactions that the network has finalized, like a page in its record book
CloudWatch	AWS's logs and metrics service, where every Lambda writes what it did
Cost ceiling	The most one agent run may spend on models and services; near it the agent switches to a cheaper model, and at it the run stops
DeepBook	Sui's shared order book, where many apps draw on the same pool of buy and sell orders
Done-When	A check anyone can run that says a piece of work is finished, written before the work starts
DynamoDB	AWS's database that stores records by a key and needs no server to manage
Escrow	Holding a payment until the service delivers, then refunding it if a deadline passes
EventBridge Scheduler	An AWS service that starts a function at a set time or on a repeating schedule
Fail closed	When a check breaks, times out or lacks the data it needs, its answer is no
Gas station	A service that pays other people's network fees, here within a capped budget
Gasless transfer	Sending a stablecoin without paying the network fee in the chain's own token
GENIUS Act	The 2025 US law that sets who may issue a payment stablecoin and how it must be backed
IAM role	A set of AWS permissions that code takes on for a short time, instead of holding a password or key

Term	Plain meaning
Kill switch	A fast way to stop an agent: here, revoking its spending cap, pausing its schedule and denying its role
KMS	AWS Key Management Service, which keeps keys inside secure hardware and signs with them there
Lambda	AWS's way to run a function without managing a server; it runs on demand and bills per request
Layer 1	A blockchain that settles its own transactions with its own validators, such as Sui
Move	The programming language for Sui code, built so a digital asset cannot be copied or lost by mistake
Near-miss log	A record of every payment the gate refused or sent for approval, with its reason, read for warnings before a real loss
Object	Sui's basic unit of data: every coin, cap and receipt is an object with an owner
OIDC	A standard that lets GitHub prove who it is to AWS and receive short-lived credentials, so no AWS key is stored
Payment Intents	A Sui feature that settles one request across several apps in a single transaction
Programmable transaction block	One Sui transaction that chains up to 1,024 steps, all of which succeed or fail together
Rail	The network and rules a payment travels on, such as a blockchain or a card network
Release manifest	One file per deploy listing exactly which model, prompts, tools, Move packages and caps are running
Seal	Sui's encryption with access control, which decides who can read stored data

Term	Plain meaning
Sponsored transaction	A transaction whose network fee someone else pays, so a new user needs no SUI
Stablecoin	A token designed to hold a steady value, such as one US dollar
Synthetic dollar	A token that tracks a dollar through offsetting trades rather than cash reserves
Test network	A practice blockchain where all money is free and worthless
Test set	A fixed list of tasks with known right answers that every change must pass
Tokenized money-market fund	Shares in a fund of short-term government debt, recorded as tokens on a blockchain
Traffic class	A tag on every model call saying what it was for, such as an agent run, a test or a reader request, so costs can be split by purpose
Validator	A computer that checks and records a blockchain's transactions
Walrus	Sui's storage network for large files, such as a library of cited sources
Well-Architected Framework	AWS's six-pillar checklist for judging a cloud design
Write-back gate	The checkpoint between what an agent proposes and anything that changes the world, such as a payment
X-Ray	AWS's tracing service, which follows one request through every function it touches
zkLogin	A Sui sign-in that creates a wallet from a familiar login without revealing that login on the chain

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